



Lost at sea

Calif. father vanishes on anniversary cruise

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Trump chides UN
on 'bully' Iran:

I DID
WHAT YOU
WOULDN'T!

President Trump defended the Iran war in an address to the UN Tuesday, saying that the country was "the bully of the Middle East" and he had "no interest in leaving dangers to grow for another day." He said he still preferred to negotiate with Iran, but could "annihilate" them if a deal doesn't happen.

PAGES 4-5

Spencer Platt/Reuters

UNITED NATIONS WEEK

DON'S WARNING

By JOSH CHRISTENSON
and STEVEN NELSON

UNITED NATIONS — President Trump called on United Nations members to support the US war effort against Iran on Tuesday, as he revealed he's weighing a dramatic military escalation that would "drive them into hell."

Trump received applause from most of the foreign dignitaries on hand while vowing to stop Iran from building a nuclear weapon, saying he was "settling years of unfinished business" — with the Iran delegation storming out of the hall.

Cuban officials also walked out later in the speech as Trump predicted the communist government "will fall" and accused Havana of supporting socialist politicians in the US.

"I have a big decision to make: Will a deal be made with Iran that lets them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before, maybe one of the greatest in the Middle East?" the president said during his 38-minute address. "Or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic and do it quickly, never giving them a chance to kill and destroy people and countries again? Do I drive them into hell with no chance of survival and no hope of future greatness for generations?"

No election reprieve

Trump also warned Iranian officials not to count on the Nov. 3 congressional elections to win them a reprieve.

"I believe we'll make a deal right after the election because it doesn't make sense for them not to. They're waiting to see how I do in the midterm election. What they don't realize is that I'm not running," he said.

"The Republican Party is running, and I'll be helping them. But I am not running," Trump added, despite encouraging GOP voters to act as if he's on the ballot.

"I gave absolutely no credence and will not give credence to the election when it comes to Iran. It doesn't even enter my mind. The only thing that does is that Iran will never have a nuclear weapon," he insisted.

Trump framed the conflict as unavoidable after he attempted to negotiate a nuclear deal with Tehran. "We are settling years of

Tells UN he'll
'annihilate' Iran
without a deal

YOU'RE THE MAN: President Trump on Tuesday at the United Nations General Assembly acknowledges outgoing Secretary-General Antonio Guterres, who's stepping down after a decade.

Side meet with Tehran

President Trump revealed Tuesday that his special envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner held a three-hour meeting with Iranian leaders on the sidelines of the United Nations General Assembly.

The sit-down began around 10 a.m. — even as the president threatened to ramp up the war to "drive them into hell" during his speech to the annual gathering of world leaders.

It was not immediately clear who represented Iran, though

the President Masoud Pezeshkian and Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi were in New York to attend UN events.

"It was a very good meeting," Trump said just before 2 p.m.

"I can't imagine why they wouldn't want to [make a deal]. It's potential greatness or obliteration. It's two choices.

"They had a very good meeting, very productive meeting, and they have another one scheduled in the very near future," Trump said.

unfinished business. And we're doing it well. There is no better example of a danger that was allowed to gather strength at the world's peril than the number one sponsor of terror, the Islamic Republic of Iran," he said.

"After giving Iran every chance for a deal, I took action to ensure that neither the United States nor any nation . . . would ever have to face such a nightmare.

"Even after we agreed to a cease-fire for nuclear discus-

sions, Iran promptly violated it with brazen acts of terrorism against civilian ships from other countries."

Trump praised the UN's Security Council for voting to condemn what he called "Iran's despicable terrorist attacks on commercial shipping" before chastising domestic critics of the war, including government sources who have claimed the military is running low on munitions.

"The cowards and traitors

It was the first known high-level negotiation between the two sides since a cease-fire and memorandum of understanding collapsed in July.

Witkoff declined to elaborate, telling the press, "I feel very good right now."

Trump delivered his annual speech to the General Assembly around 10:30 a.m. and Iranian diplomats walked out as he began to threaten further devastation of their country.

Steven Nelson

would love to say the United States is low on munitions, but that's not true," he told the assembly. "Massive munition plants will be opening. There are 18 of them being built."

On the issue of AI

Trump also responded to earlier speakers who called for restrictions on artificial intelligence, saying the US "totally rejects any attempt to construct a



globalist scheme to control for the artificial intelligence being spoken of so much now.

"I'm not going to stifle growth of something that will be bigger than the industrial revolution," the president said. "Many say bigger than the industrial revolution or the internet itself. And we will be very careful."

Trump promised his Justice Department will "watch it closely," along with "other law enforcement bodies that will rein things

BEFORE WORLD



Expats' NY rage at death spree

By REUVEN FENTON
and RONNY REYES

Thousands of protesters gathered outside the United Nations headquarters in Manhattan on Tuesday to demand an end to Iran's execution of political prisoners and to establish a free democracy in the country.

The demonstration, led by the National Council of Resistance of Iran (NCRI), called for world leaders at the UN General Assembly to act and force the Islamic republic to end the latest surge in executions, with at least 100 political prisoners currently on death row.

Maryam Rajavi, president-elect of the NCRI, slammed the presence of Iranian leaders, including President Masoud Pezeshkian, at the UN meeting as she and rallygoers called for an end to the current regime.

"As long as this regime remains in power, repression, executions, terrorism and warmongering will continue," Rajavi said in a video call-in. "The solution is regime change by the Iranian people and their organized resistance."

Iran has seen an execution spree since a brutal crackdown on protesters in January, with at least 56 people hung on national-security-related charges since March 19, according to the UN.

United Nations human-rights chief Volker Türk warned last month that more than 100 people were facing death sentences under the regime.

Iranian activist Zahra Amnampour echoed the need to forego the Islamic republic and the monarchy of the past, calling for democracy to take root in the country to ensure the freedom for all Iranians.

"The unfinished promise of generations of Iranian struggle is the right of the Iranian people themselves to determine what comes next," she said.

SHAME! A crowd of protesters on Tuesday near the United Nations calls for an end to a spree of executions in Iran in the wake of that nation's brutal suppression of public dissent in January.

Robert Miller

Recruiting kids for 'sacrifice'

Iran has a new military recruitment drive aimed at boys between the ages of 12 and 15 as part of the Islamic republic's "self-sacrifice" campaign.

Campaign spokesperson Sasan Zare said age 15 and up have begun the military train-

ing, and due to high demand "special training appropriate for younger ages will also be arranged," the Iranian Labor News Agency reported.

The training is set to begin this week as part of Iran's Janfada, or self-sacrifice, cam-

paign, which touts the slogan, "We have one life, and we give it for Iran." Kids would learn the basics of "ensuring local security, general war preparations, observation, surveillance and intelligence measures," Zare said. Ronny Reyes

in if we have to do that."

"But we will only encourage superintelligence. We're going to encourage it, not rein it in," he added, after resisting mounting calls for regulation by congressional Democrats.

"Americans have never been a nation that retreats from a frontier or shrinks from a challenge."

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California Post, Wednesday, September 23, 2026 californiapost.com

PEOPLE not fully schooled in the ways of Donald Trump might have expected to watch a somewhat chastened and shrunken president address the United Nations Tuesday morning.

After all, the war in Iran has fallen far short of his promise of a quick and decisive victory. And because the American economy has been battered by rising prices on food, fuel and pretty much everything else, polls are unanimous in saying the president is hemorrhaging support and predicting his party will get thrashed in the midterm elections.

But the Trump who spoke for almost 40 minutes from the General Assembly podium was anything but chastened and shrunken. With the world's eyes on him, he was as bullish as ever on America, the war against Iran and the distinctive differences his presidency has achieved at home and around the world. In a key sequence aimed at both domestic and foreign audiences, he boasted that "While others have ignored threats, I have confronted them. While others have talked of courage, America has shown it. While others have promised strength, I have used it to make America the most powerful country in the world."

He added that, while "Working with many nations in this room, we are solving decades of intractable challenges — and we are settling years of unfinished business."

Taking on terror

As sweeping as those claims were, they mere prelude to his main point: that Iran was and is the best example of a dangerous problem that gathered strength because others refused to stop it. It was the first of many direct punches he would throw at his Oval Office predecessors, the UN and its members.

After correctly calling Iran "the world's number one sponsor of terror," he said, "From the first day I entered the political arena, I have been unwavering — I will never allow Iran to have a nuclear weapon."

The boast has the advantage of being absolutely true because Iran and its terror proxies were main targets of his first campaign and first term in the White House.

At the time, the Islamist regime had reached the zenith of its power after gaining money, momentum and weaponry during the two terms of Barack Obama. One of the permanent stains of his tenure is that Obama crafted a weak



deal with the murderous mullahs that actually helped to fund their quest for nukes and their terror proxies.

Unfortunately, Trump is also right when he says that he and America largely stood alone when he took the oath in January of 2017. He might have added, except for Israel.

From there, in a kind of confession, he added that he now has another big decision to make:

"Will a deal be made with Iran that lets them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before, maybe one of the greatest in the Middle East or even the world?" he said. "Or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic and do it quickly, never giving them a chance to kill and destroy people and countries again? Do I drive them into hell with no chance of survival and no hope of future greatness or generations?"

That, to put it mildly, is not the kind of brutally honest talk usually spoken in the halls of the East Side puzzle palace. Moreover, Trump followed with another surprise:

"I believe we'll make a deal, right after the election," he said of Iran. "Because it doesn't make sense for them not to. They're

waiting to see how I do on the midterm election. What they don't realize is that I'm not running."

Backroom dealing

As if on cue, the president's team said later that envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner had met with Iranian officials for three hours on the sidelines. Trump told reporters it "was a very good meeting."

Additionally, Secretary of State Marco Rubio confirmed it was possible Trump would meet with Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, who along with foreign minister, Abbas Araghchi, is in New York for the opening session.

"The president is open to a meeting with anybody," Rubio told Fox News.

As I wrote Sunday, that with Trump and the Iranian leaders in the same building, it's almost impossible to imagine he wouldn't want and get a face-to-face meeting.

Trump has never met either man, but the author of the "Art of the Deal" retains the utmost confidence in his ability to settle disputes, in real estate and matters of war and peace.

Although Rubio's comments fuel the notion the president wants a quick end to the war, Trump, by raising the possibility that a settlement might not happen until after the election, aims to buy himself political space at home.

So, too, does his decision to explain to the world audience why he launched the war in the first place.

"We are settling years of unfinished business. And we're doing it well. There is no better example of a danger that was allowed to gather strength at the world's peril than the number one sponsor of terror, the Islamic Republic of Iran," he said.

"After giving Iran every chance for a deal, I took action to ensure that neither the United States nor any nation... would ever have to face such a nightmare."

It underscored his role as commander in chief, but I found it striking that he did not mention that the US had partnered with Israel in the current war and in the 12-day conflict last year.

Most notably, however, Trump did reference both the 25th anniversary of 9/11, and the Hamas invasion of Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, as evidence that terrorism remains a threat to civilized nations everywhere. He also recounted the back and forth in recent months since the cease-fire was reached in late April. Ever since, Iran has continued to target our Arab allies in the region, several of which are home to American military bases.

The president's central point was that he has offered Iran many opportunities to end the conflict, but has found no partner for peace.

Positives of a pact

Although he professes not to care about the impact on the midterms, Trump knows that a Democratic sweep of Congress would tie his hands for the remaining two years of his term. It would also bog him down in probes of his family's fishy business dealings and could lead to impeachment charges.

On the other hand, settling the Iran conflict could serve as an insurance policy for the next two years and his legacy.

Most significantly, a lasting truce would drive down oil prices, which would instantly lift the economy, both at home and globally.

Go for it, Mr. President.

Hot 'news' on Weiss

Duties could grow



PARAMOUNT'S mega-merger with Warner Bros. Discovery is finally in the clear — and hopes and fears that **Bari Weiss** is now poised to become the queen of TV news broadcasting are coming to a head.

It's no secret the 42-year-old editor-in-chief of CBS News has been eyeing a takeover of the left-leaning CNN as Paramount's \$81 billion acquisition of the cable network's owner WBD is getting cleared in a truce with 12 state attorneys general led by California Attorney General **Rob Bonta**.

"Bari is large and in charge," one media industry executive told me this week, recounting the Tuesday-morning chatter in media circles.

A well-placed source close to the situation, however, countered just hours later that speculation that Weiss is about to take control of CNN "couldn't be further from the truth."

The question of Weiss' future has been a constant source of speculation in the media business since **David Ellison** appointed the former opinion columnist to run CBS ahead of his hard-fought purchase of WBD.

Driving all of this has been Ellison's conviction that the news business needs to reflect less progressive media bias. Ellison hired Weiss to provide more centrist coverage of the news at the famously woke Tiffany Network.

It's notable that Ellison has stuck by Weiss throughout her controversial reign at CBS, including the turmoil at "60 Minutes," where he has supported her recent, unorthodox hires to change the face of the famed news magazine.

After Bonta finally cut a deal, it seemed like a given that Ellison would flex his power by

giving Weiss more clout.

So what's going to happen? A spokeswoman declined to comment, but just connecting the dots, you can see why Ellison might be hesitant to give Weiss the gargantuan task of running two major news divisions.

Stay tuned . . .

Weiss is no dummy, of course. She created the successful news website "The Free Press," which Ellison bought as part of his move to make her CBS News chief. Yet her tenure at CBS has been controversial even if Ellison is a strong believer in the non-woke ethos she's bringing to coverage. A major question is whether it's working from a business standpoint.

As *The Post* reported, "60 Minutes'" second episode in its first season under Weiss and her handpicked EP **Nick Bilton** did pretty well — over 6.5 million viewers Sunday, a bit more than last year — but the audience share fell from its first episode by around 18%.

A few weeks of mixed ratings aren't enough to go on, but David Ellison and dad Larry and their partners at RedBird Capital now have the arduous task of running a company with \$80 billion in debt and a directive to find what investment bankers call "synergies" between businesses where there's overlap like CNN and CBS.

People close to the Ellisons say they will likely bring in outside management. That will mean cuts or as another media insider put it: "They're going to slash and burn to make their numbers."

She could be given some responsibilities over CNN, but I am told the Ellisons don't want her bogged down in the heavy lifting of the "slash and burn," so "she can focus on working with talent."

Focusing on working with talent doesn't sound like running two major news divisions.

In other words, stay tuned.

Eye, caramba!



CNN



CBS



CNN boss Mark Thompson is set to lead a staff town hall regarding the merger between Paramount, led by CEO David Ellison (left), and Warner Brothers Discovery. Employees fear a chainsaw massacre after seeing the overhaul of CBS News under boss Bari Weiss.

By ALEXANDRA STEIGRAD

Staffers at CNN are in a panic over Paramount's impending takeover of the cable news channel's parent company Warner Bros. Discovery — and the massive bloodbath that is expected to come after CEO David Ellison completes the \$81 billion deal in the coming weeks.

Paramount settled an antitrust suit with California Attorney General Rob Bonta on Monday — clearing the way for a merged media giant that will operate both CBS News and CNN, in addition to Hollywood studios Paramount Pictures and Warner Bros., and streaming services HBO Max and Paramount+.

"People are very nervous," one CNN staffer told *The Post*. "It's dark. It's like when you do hurricane coverage. You see the storm spinning off the coast of Haiti and moving towards Florida and

you're just waiting and you're like, 'Oh, s--t.'"

"Bloodbath coming, including at CNN," a TV exec said. "That's the next big step — slashing and burning."

Paramount has said it sees at least \$6 billion in cost savings, which would translate to several thousand jobs lost in the months ahead.

'Absence of info'

Inside CNN, staffers have been more or less kept in the dark by top brass, who are themselves unsure who will be running the network once Ellison takes over.

"There's been a complete absence of information about what's going on and who is going to be in charge," a CNN staffer told *The Post*.

CNN boss Mark Thompson is set to lead a staff town hall about the merger on Wednesday. But

there's little hope of gleaning much insight on the new leadership structure until Ellison officially closes the deal.

Employees are looking at how CBS News has changed under Ellison's stewardship, pointing to the overhaul of the network under news boss Bari Weiss.

"What's been playing out at CBS News is fueling a deeper sense of dread and anxiety . . . not only how they've treated people and the editorial changes they've made, but that it's also been a disaster. The ratings are at their lowest point," said a CNN insider.

"You can't look at the ratings and say, it is working. Now they're going to try this at scale? What the f--k?" the person added.

Several sources expressed fear over how Weiss "blew up" CBS News' top-rated show, "60 Minutes," by firing Scott Pelley and other correspondents, along with slew of senior producers.

Eye, caramba!



CNN



CBS

CNN boss Mark Thompson is set to lead a staff town hall regarding the merger between Paramount, led by CEO David Ellison (left), and Warner Brothers Discovery. Employees fear a chainsaw massacre after seeing the overhaul of CBS News under boss Bari Weiss.



“That’s the next big step – slashing and burning.”

—TVexec

AP, Getty Images for The Free Press, Getty Images for The New York Times

By ALEXANDRA STEIGRAD

you’re just waiting and you’re like, ‘Oh, s--t.’ ”

there’s little hope of gleaning much insight on the new leader-

New Pa. measles warning

Health officials warned of a new measles exposure at a bustling Pennsylvania airport — marking the second recent exposure to the highly contagious virus in the state's largest city.

A person infected with measles passed through Philadelphia International Airport from Sept. 13 at 7:25 p.m. to 12:05 a.m. on Sept. 14, the Philadelphia Department of Public Health announced on Friday.

The measles-carrying individual traveled through the airport's terminals B and F and used areas connected to terminals C, D and E, the department said.

"The individual with measles was traveling through Philadelphia and did not leave the airport," health officials wrote in the statement.

The warning came just days after a separate measles exposure at the Children's Hospital of Philadelphia. Various parts of the hospital were exposed to measles, the department said.

Travelers at the airport during the exposure time who are not immune to measles or are unsure of their vaccination should contact a health provider. *Zoe Hussain*

'Penalty' for crude signs

A Long Island high school promised Tuesday to discipline a handful of students who taunted a rival football team by flashing crude signs with their girlfriends' pictures, names and tasteless messages.

Sachem School District Superintendent Patti Trombetta apologized for the incident at Friday's game against William Floyd, when some students held sickening signs, including a poster that showed a player and his girlfriend and asked who was "easier to score on."

Another sign read that they wanted to "touchdown" on an opposing player's girlfriend. *Alex Mitchell*

IT'S 'WARE IT'S AT

By EMILY FU

The migration to Delaware's beaches is no longer just about retirees hunting for a cheaper place to spend their golden years.

As residents continue to flock to the First State's tiny coastline, the influx is reshaping everything from the homes being built to the farmland surrounding its beach towns.

Low property taxes, no state sales tax and access to the beach have been major draws, particularly for residents arriving from high-tax New York and New Jersey and even neighboring Pennsylvania.

As The Post previously reported, more than 40,000 people have moved to Delaware's Sussex County since 2020, swelling its population by 17% — roughly five times the national growth rate.

Delaware's population of residents 65 and older, meanwhile, surged 23% over the same period, more than any other state, as retirees increasingly looked beyond traditional destinations such as Florida.

Pennsylvania couple Maggie, 64, and Vince Dominici, 70, are among those putting down roots along the Delaware coast. Vince is retired and lives full-time in Delaware, while Maggie still works and divides her time between Bethany Beach and Bethlehem, Pa.

They discovered Bethany Beach in July 2020 while searching for a family beach house. After spending a day exploring coastal Sussex County, they returned for a week-long rental in August, bought the house in September and closed that November.

The home needed work, and Vince initially preferred moving farther inland, where their money could buy a newer property. Maggie held out for the location. Vince now calls it "the best thing we ever disagreed on."

The couple later downsized to a smaller residence in Bethlehem and expanded and remodeled the Bethany Beach house, which has become the family's primary gathering place.

Their younger son, Devon Dominici, took the Delaware plunge even further. After living in his parents' beach house while working remotely during the



pandemic, Devon built a four-bedroom, 3½-bath home of his own in Ocean View, about 2 miles from Bethany Beach.

'Nowhere else to go'

Property records show the newly built home transferred for nearly \$600,000 in April 2023. A bank appraisal conducted in May valued it at 39% more than what it cost him to build, Devon said.

He believes proximity to the water will continue to underpin values in communities such as

Bethany Beach, Ocean View, Dewey Beach and Rehoboth Beach, where developable land close to the coastline is limited.

"There's really nowhere else to go," he said. "So you're buying existing inventory."

Lee Ann Wilkinson, who has worked in Delaware real estate for decades, said buyers from other states have been retiring to the Delaware beaches for roughly 20 years. What has changed visibly is the amount and type of housing being created to accommodate them.

Sussex County itself issued 3,885 building permits in 2025, according to Census Bureau data.

Many retiring buyers want low-maintenance communities where landscaping is handled for them, along with clubhouses, pools and social activities. First-floor primary bedrooms are another priority.

Developers have even adapted for transplants.

"A lot of people are looking for basements now, which we didn't 20 years ago," Wilkinson told The Post. "Now there's a lot of homes with a basement because the people that are moving here are accustomed to having basements, so they had to start building basements here."

Jen Barrows, a coastal Delaware broker, said a typical retiree she works with has a budget of roughly \$400,000 to \$800,000.

Even buyers who sell a New York-area home for \$1 million or more frequently don't want to pour all of the proceeds into their next house, she said.

"They want to bank some of that money," Barrows said. "They don't want to spend it all on their next house."

Instead, many look several miles inland, where large planned communities offer amenities while keeping residents within reach of the coast.



Tiffany Caldwell/www.tifpics.com

Tiffany Caldwell/www.tifpics.com

ELECTION 2026

DEMS' DEATH

Calif. lefties cool on Gavin & Kam

By ZAIN KHAN

Kamala Harris and Gavin Newsom are both drawing low levels of enthusiasm for potential 2028 presidential bids, with the California governor holding a lead over Harris among the state's Democratic voters in a new poll.

The September survey, conducted by the UC Berkeley Citrin Center and Politico, found that 37% of registered California voters said they would be excited about a Newsom presidential run, compared with 28% who said the same about Harris.

The figures mark a substantial decline from the February-March survey, when 48% of registered voters said they were excited about a Newsom bid and 41% were excited about Harris entering the race.

The poll comes as Newsom vowed not to run against Harris, telling CNN he would not challenge the former vice president.

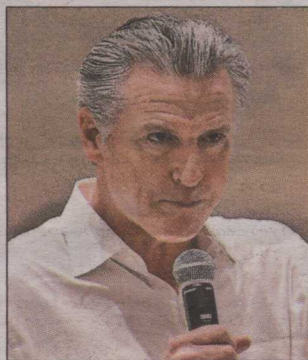
"I don't know if she runs but we'll see," Newsom said in Montana. "But I wouldn't run if she ran."

The term-limited governor, who is also under a DOJ investigation along with his wife, is publicly weighing a run for the White House in 2028.

Newsom has been a front-runner alongside Harris, so much so that he is dominating among Democratic voters.

Some 61% said they would be excited about Newsom running for president, compared with 39% who said they would not.

Harris' numbers were reversed: 55% of Democratic and Democratic-leaning voters said they would not be excited about another presidential bid



from the former vice president. "There's no question that Democrats see Newsom as the stronger general election prospect, even if neither he nor Harris is generating much excitement, and that shines through," Jon Cohen, founder of polling company TrueDot, told Politico.

Ran in same circles

If Harris were to run in 2028, it would be her third attempt to win the White House.

Harris launched a campaign for the 2020 Democratic presidential nomination. She dropped out in December 2019, before the primaries began. Joe Biden later selected her as his running mate.

In 2024, she became the Democratic nominee after Biden ended his re-election bid. She lost the election to Donald Trump.

The survey also found a sizable gap in how Democrats view the two Californians' prospects for 2028. Forty-nine percent of Democrats said Newsom has the better chance of securing the Democratic nomination,

compared with just 10% who selected Harris.

The difference was even larger when respondents were asked about the general election.

Fifty-nine percent of Democrats said Newsom was more likely to win a general election, while just 9% chose Harris.

Harris, 61, and Newsom 58, came up in San Francisco politics at the same time, building careers that often ran in parallel. In 2004, Harris became San Francisco district attorney while Newsom became mayor.

Harris later became California attorney general and then a US senator before vice president, while Newsom became lieutenant governor and later governor.

Outside the Democratic base, enthusiasm was considerably lower for both potential candidates.

About 85% of independent voters said they were not excited about either Newsom or Harris running in 2028, according to the figures from the September survey.

Among Republicans, roughly 93% said they were not excited about either candidate.

The poll comes as many issues have taken center stage in California, with a statewide election set for November. Crime and homelessness have become key concerns, while affordability remains on voters' minds.

Many Californians say the state has become too expensive, with some of the highest taxes in the country.

The Post has reached out to both Harris' and Newsom's camps for comment.

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David Gurnick/USA Today Network/Reuters Connect



ODD COUPLE: Michigan Senate hopeful Abdul El-Sayed (left), appears with former Vice Prez Kamala Harris (right), yesterday at a forum on black maternal health care which Harris said was being hurt by attacks on DEI initiatives.

Harris joins El

Former Vice President Kamala Harris blasted criticism of diversity, equity, and inclusion initiatives as an "attack on maternal care" while stumping for Michigan Senate hopeful Dr. Abdul El-Sayed in Detroit.

"The attack on DEI is an attack on maternal care ... including the need to protect black women in connection with their pregnancy, childbirth and postpartum care,"

Harris said during a roundtable event with El-Sayed.

"These are the facts when we talk about what is at stake in this moment as it relates to these midterms ..."

The event was intended to shore up El-Sayed's support with black voters after he had soft support from the critical voting bloc in the Democratic primary last month.

Ironically, El-Sayed had

AOC: It's '28 win or bust!

New York Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez has claimed that if she runs for her seat again or for the Senate or White House in 2028 and doesn't win, that's the end of her time in office.

"It's very all-or-nothing," the far-left Dem, 36, (right) told The New York Times. "If I were to run in this cycle and not win, I would be done."

The Queens and Bronx rep is currently mulling whether to run for the presidency in 2028 or to seek New York Demo-

WISH FOR DON

By RYAN KING

WASHINGTON — Democrats are so desperate to see President Trump out of office that a majority would be happy to see him overthrown in a military coup or die in his sleep, a jaw-dropping new poll has found.

Nearly 6 in 10 (59%) of Democratic respondents said they would feel “very positive” or “somewhat positive” if the US military removed Trump and seized control of the government, while 55% said they would feel the same if Trump passed away peacefully, according to the Center for Strategic Politics survey.

An even higher percentage said they would be happy if Trump were impeached and removed from office (87%) or ousted by his Cabinet via the 25th Amendment (84%).

The results were released ahead of the Nov. 3 midterm elections, in which Democrats are heavily favored to regain control of the House of Representatives after four years in the minority.

Pressure to impeach

House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries (D-NY) has kept open the possibility of impeaching Trump for a third time.

“No, we haven’t ruled anything in and we haven’t ruled anything out in terms of impeachment,” Jeffries told ABC News’ “This Week” Sept. 13. “We’ve got to follow the facts.”

But the poll illustrates the intense pressure Jeffries and other Democratic leaders are feeling from their base to go scorched-earth against Trump.

The survey also found nearly one-third of Democrats (32%) said they would feel “very” or “somewhat positive” if Trump were assassinated at a rally, while 43% said they would feel “very” or “somewhat negative” about the news.

Exactly one-quarter of respondents said they would have a neutral reaction to news of Trump’s murder.

Beyond removing Trump from office, respondents also overwhelmingly favored having the next Democratic administration prosecute members of his administration involved with immigration enforcement efforts (77%), the war in Iran (66%), and boat strikes against suspected drug

Democrats want Trump out by (almost) any means necessary

If you woke up tomorrow morning and saw the following news headlines, how would you feel?

Very positive Somewhat positive Neither positive nor negative
Somewhat negative Very negative

President Donald Trump has been impeached and convicted by both houses of Congress and has been removed from office

75% 12% 7% +80

Using the 25th Amendment to the Constitution, President Donald Trump has been declared unfit by a majority of his cabinet and removed from office

70% 14% 9% +77

President Donald Trump died overnight in his sleep

45% 10% 28% 10% +77

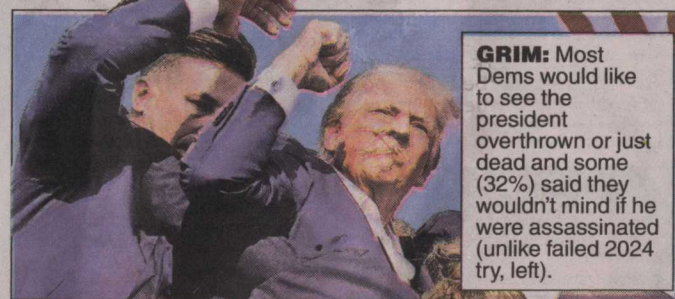
To “safeguard the Constitution”, a group of U.S. military leaders have removed President Donald Trump from power and assumed control of the United States

43% 16% 13% 10% 18% +32

President Donald Trump was assassinated while speaking at a rally

23% 9% 25% 11% 32% -12

SMS-to-web and online panel survey of 683 Democratic voters conducted 9/3 and 9/8-10. MOE=±3.75%. Source: Liberal Currents / Center for Strategic Politics



Happy if he dies in his sleep: poll

traffickers (72%).

More than half of Democrats (57%) also backed criminal prosecutions of both Trump and Biden administration officials over the Israel-Hamas war as well as ending the Senate’s legislative filibuster (52%), while more than two-thirds favored expanding the Supreme Court (69%).

Former Vice President Kamala Harris was the pick of potential

2028 contenders among the respondents, with 25% deeming her their first choice, followed by California Gov. Gavin Newsom (15%), former Transportation Secretary Pete Buttigieg (13%), Sen. Jon Ossoff of Georgia (10%), Sen. Mark Kelly of Arizona (9%), and Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez of New York (8%).

The poll has an error margin of plus or minus 3.75 points.



to rip DEI foes

backed the “uncommitted” movement in the 2024 cycle, a revolt against former President Joe Biden getting the nod. Harris was set to be on Biden’s ticket at the time. Many movement organizers also refused to back Harris.

Earlier in the day Tuesday, El-Sayed snapped when a journalist asked about his support for the “uncommitted” movement.

“Was Vice President Harris

running for president at the time we were uncommitted?” he asked. “I mean ask a fact-based question, then I’ll answer your question.”

Around the time Harris replaced Biden atop the Democratic ticket, El-Sayed’s half-sister Eman Abdelhadi publicly trashed her.

Ultimately, El-Sayed backed Harris, citing his concerns about President Trump.

Ryan King

cratic Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer’s seat. Schumer has been coy about whether he will run again.

AOC has repeatedly said she won’t make a decision on 2028 until she sees how her fellow progressives do in the midterms, recently telling The Post, “We will learn a lot in November.”

She is now averaging fourth

place in the latest RealClearPolitics view of the most likely 2028 Democratic candidates



But it’s early and AOC sounds serious. “There’s an argument that some make that this is a very unique political window and, oftentimes in politics, you do only get one shot,” she said. “In general, life doesn’t wait for you to be ready for things.”

Ryan King

**HO-YIN MO**

Apprehended by the feds.

DHS nab aide to Dem pol

A California Democrat's staffer has been arrested by federal immigration authorities in Las Vegas, according to the Department of Homeland Security.

Former KTSF news anchor Ho-Yin Mo, who now works for California Assemblywoman Catherine Stefani, was taken into custody Thursday at Harry Reid International Airport, the Daily Mail reported.

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Stefani's office released a statement saying: "I am respectfully calling for Ho Yin Mo's release as soon as possible. Ho Yin is a selfless public servant and a valued, legal employee of the California State Legislature serving our San Francisco and Bay Area communities."

Mo joined her office in 2025. *Zain Khan*

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The show may leave for Georgia or Tennessee, according to TMZ. While no decision has been made, Fremantle and Simon Cowell's Syco are reportedly looking to move ahead of Season 22. The show is wrapping up its 21-season production run at the Pasadena Civic Auditorium this week.

"American Idol" is also relocating its production from LA to the Atlanta area. *Sheetal Banchariya*

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Redlands father ID'd in cruise plunge

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The couple lived with their three sons in Redlands, about 63 miles east of Los Angeles.

A computer programmer who spent 24 years working for Esri, Gigler is believed to have

gone off the 11th deck as the ship traveled from Mexico toward Long Beach. His family raised the alarm after he could not be found. He is presumed dead.

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The US and Mexican Coast Guards continued searching the area, while the Mexican Navy and nearby commercial vessels also joined the effort.

Gigler's family has been left struggling to understand what happened. His sister, Wendy Dowden, pushed back on a fellow passenger's claim that Gigler had spoken about problems in his marriage during a conversation at the ship's Alchemy Bar the night before his disappearance.

Dowden told the Daily Mail that her brother and Michelle "were getting along quite well," rejecting the suggestion that marital problems had driven him to jump.

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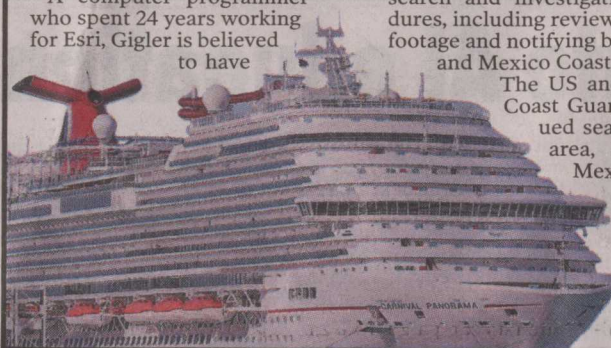
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dfarr@californiapost.com



Nothing out-rage-ous from Ari

Page Six[®]
Hollywood

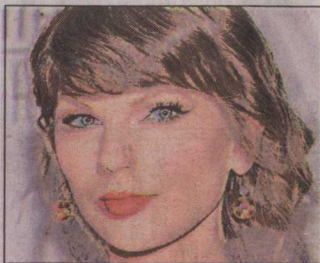
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Tim Baysinger
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Fam's de-Parton

DOLLY Parton's nephew, **Bryan Seaver**, slammed her manager, **Danny Nozell**, and Pinnacle Bank after being fired from his longtime post as head of security. Seaver and his team told TMZ Monday they are "dismayed by the unexpected and, so far, unexplained actions" taken since Parton's death on Aug. 25. "We refuse to be intimidated by those whose actions we believe are being taken in bad faith and with the intent to profit from the life of someone who willingly gave so much," they said. Page Six has reached out to Seaver. Seaver — who announced the country icon's death at 80 — and his security companies were dismissed from Parton's properties via a notice last week, according to TMZ.



'Patient'ly waiting

TAYLOR Swift is single again! Sorry — Taylor Swift HAS a single again. Swift (above) shocked fans with an announcement yesterday that she's releasing a new song titled "Patient Zero." "I've been impatiently waiting to tell you," the Grammy winner wrote on Instagram, revealing the song's name and its Friday release. She noted the single could be pre-ordered for \$3.99 on her website for 24 hours. The regular and acoustic-version CDs were sold out by the evening.

IN a town where aura layering, somatic unwinding and microdosing are de rigueur, **Ari Emanuel**'s new memoir "Roll the Calls" is an incongruous LA ode to rage.

The staccato-prosed memoir blends business management techniques and Hollywood history, wrapped in a personal story about one man unapologetically embracing his aggression. Emanuel, who has long struggled with ADHD and dyslexia, opens on the word "rage," which the author and his ghostwriter, **J.R. Moehringer**, establish as the central motif of Emanuel's life — not to mention the "secret sauce" of his professional success.

Over the next 400-plus pages, Emanuel uses an

array of personal and professional anecdotes most of which are laced with his uncontrollable rage to try and elicit a range of emotions from his readers: awe for his work ethic and cunning; sympathy for the man willing to publicly bear his psychic scars; revulsion for his vulgarity and treatment of certain friends and colleagues — his former partner **Patrick Whitesell** being one of them — who failed to match his manic drive.

Memoirs allow powerful individuals to control their narratives. But Emanuel doesn't seem overly concerned with winning over his readers. He's an anti-hero who works tirelessly for the good of his clients and his colleagues. And yet, by the end of the book it's

unclear if anyone is actually rooting for him.

That's largely because for a typical reader his volatility and incivility is hard to stomach. Does calling Amazon's **Jeff Bezos** and former Disney CEO **Bob Iger** "motherf---ers" to their faces make Emanuel a truth-teller? Or someone who is just unhinged?

Certain execs such as DreamWorks' **Jeffrey Katzenberg** and Miramax's **Harvey Weinstein** come in for repeated drubbings.

Few people who wield any real power today come in for any scorching criticism. That's because Emanuel, who serves in top positions at TKO Group Holdings Inc. and WME Group, still has some game left in him.

Eyes wide shut

TOM Cruise does not read. The movie superstar revealed that when he's considering a new project, "I don't read the scripts. I have them read it to me." He said on **Jason and Travis Kelce's** podcast, "I have them read it to me, because I don't want my ideas to invade it yet. I want to understand: What is their communication? They've been working on it, and they have things that are just" in their head, he said. "I'm a popcorn guy. I'm a meat-and-potatoes popcorn [guy]," explaining he puts himself in the moviegoer's shoes. He also likes to hear the wardrobe and lighting departments' plans. "Then I'm like, I know how to contribute to that motion now."



Auction Hammer

SO typical of **Armie Hammer's** family: They want an arm and a leg. Sotheby's is auctioning off 12 works belonging to late oil tycoon Armand Hammer, with proceeds benefiting the Armand Hammer Foundation. The haul is expected to fetch \$25 million to \$37 million in November and includes works by Mary Cassatt, Edgar Degas, Pierre-Auguste Renoir and Camille Pissarro, with Cassatt's painting potentially setting a new auction record for the artist. Armand is the great-grandfather of Armie (above), whose tumultuous family history was revisited in the 2022 documentary series "House of Hammer."



Engage thrusters!
Christina Aguilera does some "Dirrrty" dancing on fiancé **Matthew Rutler** aboard a yacht off Portofino, Italy.

Superagent's tome has tales of whoa!

WHILE **Ari Emanuel** spends much of his new book detailing his highs and lows in the entertainment biz the tome does have some wild behind-the-scenes details about celebs and VIPs, too. Here are a few: **Larry David** and **Elon Musk** had to be physically separated at the superagent's wedding to fashion designer **Sarah Staudinger**. David was scheduled to officiate the nuptials in St. Tropez, afterward, Emanuel recalls, "Seating Larry at the same table as Elon Musk: Not my best decision." As soon as the star sees the Tesla mogul, "he starts cursing, yelling, saying things many people

would like to say to Elon" about his politics. Emanuel argued to help **Martin Scorsese** and **Jack Nicholson** keep a scene in "The Departed" that the head of Warner Bros. said was porn and needed to be cut. "The beef involves a sex scene," including a ball gag, he writes, which Scorsese and Nicholson liked, but Warner's president **Alan Horn** was against. The agent recalls that after trying to settle the dispute, "I feel as if I'm the one gnawing the ball gag."

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COBRA TEAM/BACKGRID

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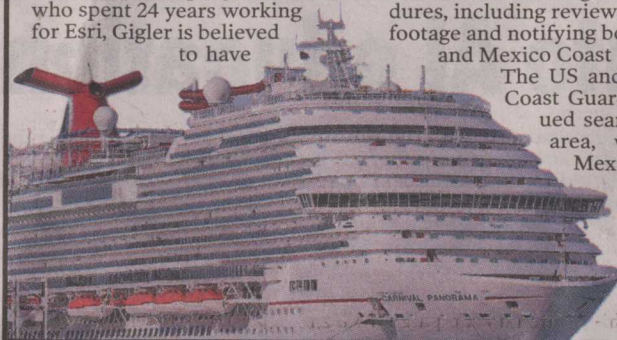
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\$20 doesn't go far in LA

Gas crisis is hellish for SoCal commute

By CHRISTOPHER EDWARDS

Drive across town, in this economy?

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Using metro-area average per-gallon prices mapped over the local road network, plus an average of 28 miles to the gallon, the cringe-inducing cartography reveals what commuters in stretched-to-the-limit SoCal already know — it's expensive to get everywhere.

According to the map, drivers today can travel 29 fewer miles for the same \$20 as they could on Feb. 27 — just before the start of the Iran war.

That's about from downtown LA to Long Beach.

The map was created by a crafty — and likely fed-up — commuter who posted his findings to Reddit.

Commenters debated about whether a driver's habits will change amid the rising cost of gas.

"Every time I see ... all the insane behavior of LA drivers I have the same thought. Maybe it's not expensive enough yet," one observer wrote.

"I think we won't see any changes to driving habits until stations begin rationing gasoline," a second said.

"Gasoline prices can go over

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The pain at the pump for West Coasters has increased exponentially of late — with gas prices jumping 19 cents in just one

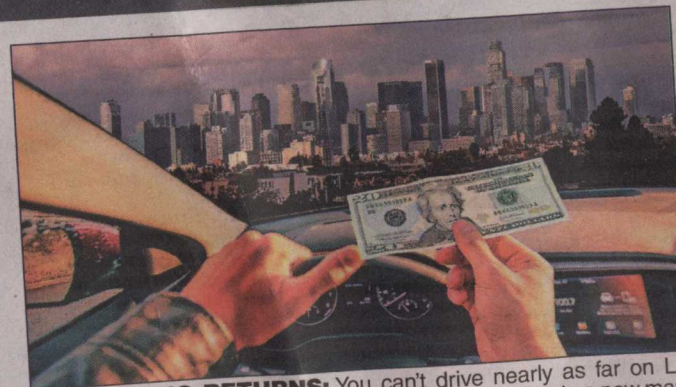
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Patrick De Haan, head of petroleum analysis at GasBuddy, told KRON4 in San Francisco that while gas prices could dip when California switches from its more expensive summer-blend gasoline to the winter blend at the end of October, prices could also rise again before then due to conflicts in the Middle East.



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Californians 80 and over can skip jury duty forever.

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Assemblyman Patrick Ahrens, who introduced the bill, said, "Seniors ... can and will continue to serve if they're willing and able to. But if they cannot, they will no longer have to jump through hoops to permanently opt

Stanford Palestine vandals off hook

Five pro-Palestine Stanford University protesters will no longer face felony charges under a pretrial diversion agreement reached Monday with California Attorney General Rob Bonta.

Instead, they will pay Stanford \$51,973 — a far lower amount than the ini-

tially estimated \$360,000 to \$1 million in damages — and will each complete 100 hours of community service.

The case dates to 2024, when pro-Palestine protests rocked college campuses nationwide as Israel escalated its campaign in Gaza.

At Stanford, the protests culminated in a break-in at the university president's office.

Protesters sought to pressure the university to divest funds from companies tied to the Israeli government.

In all, 12 people were charged with felony vandal-

ism and trespass. Seven had previously settled their cases.

Bonta's office said in a statement the new agreement brings accountability and serves "the best interests of the community and all parties involved."

Titus Wu

BX. MOM'S FURY

Son slain, endorses Tish foe

BLIND EYE: Migdalia Martinez (left) — whose 12-year-old son Jacob Freytes was gunned down by a stray bullet over the summer — blasted state Attorney General Letitia James (below) for focusing on national politics in a campaign ad endorsing challenger Saritha Komatireddy (right).

By CARL CAMPANILE

A grieving Bronx mom whose 12-year-old son was killed by a stray bullet blasted state Attorney General Letitia James for her obsession with “national politics” as she endorsed her Republican opponent.

Migdalia Martinez appears in a powerful new ad backing challenger Saritha Komatireddy for AG and talking about her son Jacob Freytes, who was killed outside a bodega in July.

“Four teenagers were shot in The Bronx in one week, and they said it’s the safest summer on record,” Martinez says, before looking directly into the camera and pointing to a necklace with a picture of her son.

“This here is my son, Jacob. He was shot and killed riding his bike to

buy a ball. Letitia James has time for national politics, just not for The Bronx,” Martinez said of the Democratic incumbent.

“I’m not political, and neither is Saritha. When I met her, I heard somebody who wants change. Saritha is the only person I’ll vote for.”

Son killed in July

The ad also shows an image of James with Mayor Mamdani.

Career criminal William Ferrer was charged in the July 25 stray-bullet killing of Jacob Freytes, who was caught in the crossfire out-

side a Mount Eden bodega.

Ferrer, who has at least a half-dozen prior arrests dating back to 1999, is accused of opening fire during a street dispute outside Wanda Deli Grocery on Elliott Place near the Grand Concourse.

Jacob — also the son of retired NYPD Detective Sgt. Jesus Freytes — had biked to the store to buy a ball when gunfire erupted, police said.

Ferrer pleaded not guilty during a court appearance last week.

Komatireddy, a former federal prosecutor and mother of four, met Martinez

shortly after the slaying and brought her to see President Trump at an event on Long Island last month. Trump embraced her and vowed to get tougher on crime at the pro-policing event.

“Families like Migdalia’s have paid an unbearable price while New York’s leaders have failed to make public safety the priority it should be. Letitia James has had almost eight years in office and the resources of a statewide law enforcement agency, yet she is failing these families,” Komatireddy said in a statement to The Post.

James has failed The Bronx since she took office in 2019, her opponent said.

James, seeking a third term, is heavily favored to win re-election.



Qns. scooter-thief killer wanted

The NYPD has released a photo of the scooter-riding brute who allegedly gunned down Malaki Adams, 14, in Queens Monday afternoon, with the shooting being probed as a targeted killing, sources said.

Pictures show Adams’ alleged killer masked-up wearing a black hoodie and checkered gray pants — and seen riding a kick scooter. Sources told The Post the alleged shooter

stole Adams’ scooter after blasting him in the back around 3:40 p.m.

The gunman may have deliberately targeted Adams (inset), who was riding his scooter when the perp ran up on him with a gun.

Adams then tried to flee from the shooter, before the creep blasted him

and sped off on it, according to sources.

He was last seen heading east-bound on Norton Avenue in Edgemere on Monday, cops said.

Adams was taken to Long Island Jewish Hospital, where he later died, cops said. Friends and neighbors were torn by the teen’s



tragic death, with many suggesting that Adams may have been the victim of violence by one of the nabe’s many gangs.

“He’s sweet and lovely,” remembered London, 16, who is friends with Adams’ sister.

London also claimed Adams’ killing was “a gang shooting,” but couldn’t say for sure whether Adams himself was in a gang.

Kevin Sheehan

Clancy's new wife fam fear

Patrick Clancy’s new wife recalled her loved ones’ “worried” reactions when she began dating the grieving ex-husband of a woman who was infamous for killing their three young children.

Rachel Danis, an infertility specialist who tied the knot with Clancy in April, opened up about their love story on “60 Minutes” after Lindsay Clancy’s triple murder trial ended with a hung jury this month.

When asked by CBS correspondent Ross Douthat how Danis’ inner circle initially responded to the news of their relationship, she hesitated while replying: “Everyone paused — um, understandably so.”

“I say everyone, I had told like a couple of close friends, and I think family members were picking up on it because they would ask what I’m doing that weekend or that evening and I would mention Pat. So people were catching on and I think people were worried,” she said.

Danis and Clancy also said they’re starting a family and are excited to tell their future child about its slain siblings.

Georgia Worrell

Holdout juror tussle

The Lindsay Clancy holdout juror’s attorney hit back at a motion filed by the killer mom’s defense team.

Edward Paltzik, who represents Michael Desronvil, spoke out Tuesday after Clancy’s attorney, Kevin Reddington, called for a judge to investigate his client’s phone records and pre-trial questionnaire answers.

“Reddington’s motion is actually a full-frontal attack on the US Constitution,” Paltzik wrote. “Because if the new normal is that jurors are going to face brutal reprisals for disagreeing with a defense attorney, you can kiss the Sixth Amendment goodbye.” Anthony Blair

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Five pro-Palestine Stanford University protesters will no longer face felony charges under a pretrial diversion agreement reached Monday with California Attorney General Rob Bonta.

Instead, they will pay Stanford \$51,973 — a far lower amount than the ini-

tially estimated \$360,000 to \$1 million in damages — and will each complete 100 hours of community service.

The case dates to 2024, when pro-Palestine protests rocked college campuses nationwide as Israel escalated its campaign in Gaza.

At Stanford, the protests culminated in a break-in at the university president's office.

Protesters sought to pressure the university to divest funds from companies tied to the Israeli government.

In all, 12 people were charged with felony vandal-

ism and trespass. Seven had previously settled their cases.

Bonta's office said in a statement the new agreement brings accountability and serves "the best interests of the community and all parties involved."

Titus Wu

Sally Brompton Daily Horoscope



DISCOVER MORE ABOUT YOURSELF AND WHAT THE FUTURE HOLDS AT
SALLYBROMPTON.COM

♍ VIRGO (Aug. 24-Sept. 23)

The more rigid your plans are for the next 24 hours the more likely it is they will fall apart. The message of the stars today Virgo is that for best results you need to stay loose and be ready to change direction at a moment's notice.

♎ LIBRA (Sept. 24-Oct. 23)

Although the Sun is now moving through your sign you probably won't notice much of a change to begin with. Come the weekend though the pace of life will pick up dramatically and you will enjoy the challenge of keeping up, so save your energy for then.

♏ SCORPIO (Oct. 24-Nov. 22)

With the Sun and Mercury moving through the most sensitive area of your chart you could be a bit touchy today, especially if you are criticized for something that isn't really your fault. Hold your tongue and let it pass. There is nothing to be gained from confrontation.

♐ SAGITTARIUS (Nov. 23 - Dec. 21)

You can be rather outspoken at times and that should be a good thing today. With both the Sun and Mercury moving in your favor you must call it as you see it even if you know it will stir up trouble. Think of it as your special role.

♑ CAPRICORN (Dec. 22 - Jan. 20)

There can be no half measures now, especially in your career. You are about to be given an opportunity to show what you can do and you must take full advantage of it. You don't want to look back later on and wish you had been more dynamic.

♒ AQUARIUS (Jan. 21 - Feb. 19)

Cosmic activity in the most adventurous area of your chart will encourage you to be more open about your dreams and

ambitions. Don't worry that other people might think you are aiming too high - worry only about failing to live up to your creative potential.

♓ PISCES (Feb. 20-March 20)

The world at large may think you are happy but on an inner level you don't feel right at all and you need to work out why that is. What occurs today will point you in the right direction, but it's you who must do the walking.

♈ ARIES (March 21-April 20)

Cosmic activity in your opposite sign means you have no choice but to work closely with others, both in your personal life and in your career. Be open and honest about what you want but be ready to listen to other people's opinions as well.

♉ TAURUS (April 21-May 21)

There will be times over the next few days when it seems as if you are the only one making much of an effort, but don't kick up a fuss about it. The powers that be will be watching you closely and will be impressed by your commitment.

♊ GEMINI (May 22-June 21)

Act as if there are no limits to what you are capable of. Your ability to make things happen are stronger at this time of year than any other, so believe you have what it takes and set targets that no one else can come close to matching.

♋ CANCER (June 22-July 23)

You may have good reason to complain about someone's unreasonable behavior towards you but if you are smart you will

suck it up and pretend it does not bother you in the slightest. Once they realize you are not going to react they will leave you alone.

♌ LEO (July 24-Aug. 23)

You may be free to come and go as you please but you must not abuse that privilege. If you feel like heading off on your own today that's okay, but make sure everyone knows where you are going and when you expect to be back.

BIRTHDAY WEDNESDAY

It's time to get serious about your life. You may think you are serious about it already but the planets indicate you have been falling short of your potential and need to up your game. Those dreams you had for yourself when you were younger are still within reach.

Post Weather Report

Wednesday



Today: Mostly sunny and warm. High 84 to 90.

Tonight: Clear. Low 65 to 71.

Friday

Sunlit. High 83 to 89.

Evening: Mainly clear. Low 63 to 69.

Thursday



Tomorrow: Sunny. High 81 to 87.

Tomorrow night: Clear. Low 65 to 71.

Saturday

Some sun. High 84 to 90.

Evening: Partly cloudy. Low 63 to 69.

Almanac

TUESDAY'S CONDITIONS AT LOS ANGELES THROUGH 2PM

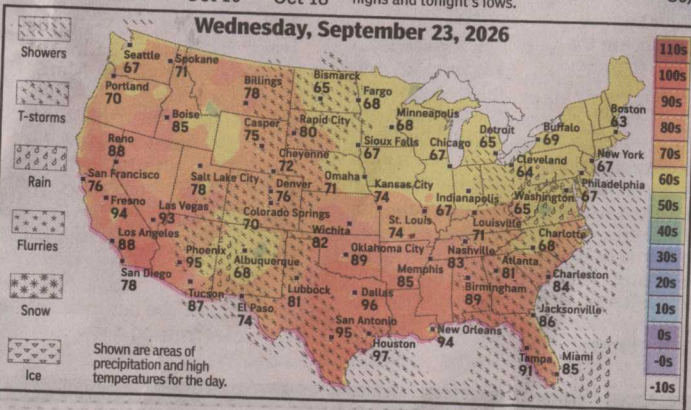
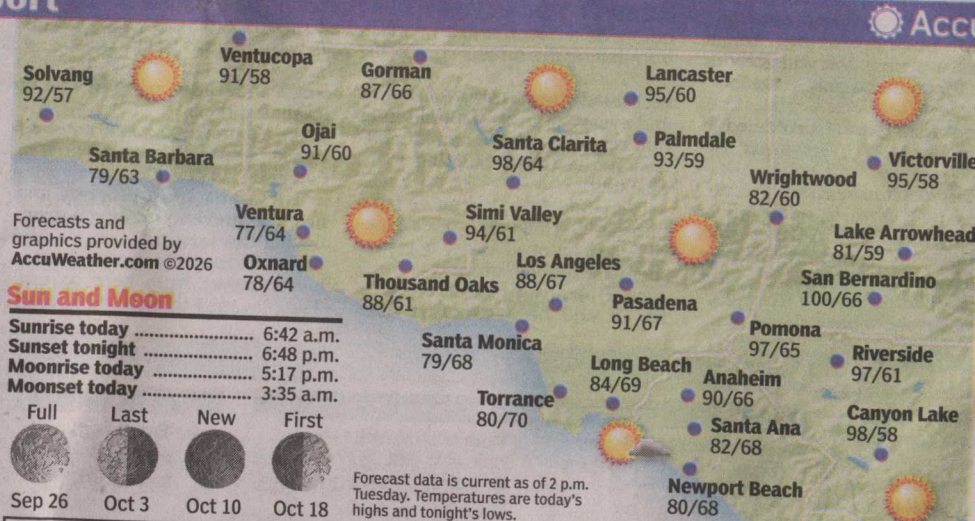
TEMPERATURE
High: 78, Low: 64, Mean: 71
Departure from Normal
Tuesday: -2 degrees

PRECIPITATION
Tuesday: 0.02", Month: 0.75",
Year: 8.09", Normal year to date: 10.41"

Cooling Degree days Tuesday.....6
Total for the month (normal).....256 (203)
Total since Jan. 1 (normal).....1591 (1048)
Last year to date.....1109
UV index (for Wed.).....6 (High)
Humidity (at noon).....51%

AIR QUALITY Source: South Coast Air Quality Mgt. District
AQI rating: (for Wed.).....Moderate

POLLEN
Grass Low Weeds Moderate
Trees Low Mold Low



AccuWeather

California Tides	TODAY	TOMORROW
High Tide for	1st 2nd	1st 2nd
Santa Barbara	8:54a 8:16p	9:12a 8:54p
Ventura	8:44a 8:07p	9:00a 8:43p
Santa Monica	8:37a 8:01p	8:54a 8:37p
Outer L.A. Harbor	8:35a 7:58p	8:51a 8:34p
Inner L.A. Harbor	8:39a 8:02p	8:55a 8:38p
Newport Bay Ent.	8:29a 7:55p	8:47a 8:31p
San Clemente	8:10a 7:41p	8:29a 8:16p
San Diego	8:25a 7:56p	8:44a 8:31p

Regional cities	TODAY	TOMORROW
Bakersfield	94/69/s	100/68/s
Death Valley	107/82/s	108/80/s
Eureka	63/49/pc	65/55/c
Fresno	94/66/s	99/66/pc
Modesto	91/60/s	97/63/s
Needles	101/75/s	101/78/s
Palm Springs	102/76/s	100/79/s
Redding	94/55/s	93/60/pc
Sacramento	91/56/s	93/58/s
San Diego	78/69/s	76/69/s
San Francisco	76/56/s	77/60/s
South Lake Tahoe	73/43/s	75/52/s
Yosemite Valley	85/55/s	85/57/s

World cities	TODAY	TOMORROW
Athens	73/54/sh	76/57/s
Baghdad	112/85/s	107/83/c
Beijing	90/67/pc	77/66/t
Berlin	68/53/pc	60/53/r
Cairo	91/74/pc	91/73/pc
Dublin	63/50/pc	67/53/c
Geneva	77/47/s	78/49/c
Hong Kong	89/79/t	91/79/s
Jerusalem	82/65/s	81/66/s
Kabul	84/61/pc	82/58/pc
London	75/52/pc	71/53/pc
Madrid	92/58/s	93/60/s
Mexico City	78/56/sh	79/55/pc
Montreal	67/44/s	70/48/s
Moscow	64/60/c	66/50/sh
Paris	78/55/pc	76/52/c
Rio de Janeiro	70/65/t	70/67/r
Rome	78/60/s	79/63/sh
Sydney	70/61/r	75/60/s
Tokyo	75/71/c	83/72/pc

Weather (W): s-sunny, pc-partly cloudy, c-cloudy, sh-showers, r-rain, t-thunderstorms, sf-snow flurries, sn-snow, i-ice



Liberty's True Heroes

HONG Kong prison guards have started formally rehearsing their procedures in case of Jimmy Lai's death behind bars. Read that sentence again.

Lai, 78 years old, has spent more than 2,000 days incarcerated in Hong Kong. In February, he was sentenced to 20 years in prison after being convicted under Hong Kong's national security law.

Last week, a new report from the Committee for Freedom in Hong Kong Foundation found that guards at Stanley Prison have been practicing what they will do if he dies in custody. That news hits me hard — because for me, Lai's story has never been an abstraction.

In 1989, I joined the democracy movement that culminated in the protests in Tiananmen Square. After the Chinese Communist Party crushed our movement, I ended up on its most-wanted list.

I was fortunate: I escaped China, came to the United States and became an attorney. I built my life in a country where the rule of law protects the individual from the power of the state.

Jimmy Lai took a different path. He stayed and built Apple Daily to champion freedom and democracy in China. And when Beijing steadily tightened its grip on Hong Kong, he refused to stay silent.

Earlier this year, after watching my daughter Alysia win Olympic gold in figure skating, I found myself reflecting as never before about what freedom had come to mean to me. Alysia's skating in Milan embodied a kind of freedom I once could barely imagine: the freedom to become yourself, to speak, to strive and even to fail without a government deciding what you are permitted to think.

Lai represents the terrible reverse of that idea. His case shows what happens when the state decides that speech itself is a threat.

Hong Kong authorities convicted Lai of two conspiracy counts involving collusion with foreign forces and another involving seditious publications. CCP officials maintain that his prosecution was legitimate, and that the city continues to operate according to the rule of law.

That's categorically untrue. More accurate: Lai's prosecution is punishment for journalism and political dissent.

There is no disputing the human reality now confronting his family. Unless something changes, and

ARTHUR LIU

fast, Lai will likely die in prison.

Before returning to the White House for a second term, President Donald Trump made them a clear commitment. In a 2024 interview, Hugh Hewitt asked Trump whether he would convince Xi Jinping to get Lai released. "100%, yes," Trump answered firmly. "100%, I'll get him out."

Now he must keep that vow. Xi Jinping arrives in Washington Wednesday for a summit with Trump and a formal state visit.

Trade, tariffs, Taiwan, artificial intelligence and other disputes between the world's two most powerful countries will crowd the agenda. Lai's name belongs at the top of the conversation.

In fact, no other topic should arise without Xi's unequivocal assent to his release. Trump needs an unmistakable win in a summit heavy on ceremony — and fulfill-

ing a promise he made before returning to office would keep critics from saying he's been played by the CCP.

For his part, Xi is facing a stagnant domestic economy that's straining under heavy public debt. Releasing an elderly prisoner could buy some much-needed international goodwill.

At their last meeting in Beijing, Xi told Trump that getting Lai out of prison would be difficult. That's a bald-faced lie: Xi is the most powerful Chinese leader since Mao Zedong.

Whatever the legal formalities, it strains credulity to suggest that Lai's fate is somehow beyond Xi's influence. The truth is that if Xi wanted Jimmy Lai free, Jimmy Lai would be free.

For those of us who remember Tiananmen, there's something painfully familiar about this. Governments may change their slogans and courtrooms may replace tanks, but the fundamental question remains: What happens to the person who will not be silenced?

As a lawyer, I find the verdicts in Hong Kong's political prosecutions acutely galling. Despite Beijing's promises of autonomy, the rule of law I have spent my career practicing no longer survives there.

It is rule by power dressed in legal robes. And Lai embodies Hong Kongers' refusal to accept that they could be so badly cheated.

This week, as Donald Trump rolls out the White House red carpet for Xi Jinping, Jimmy Lai will remain in his cell.

Trump said he would get him out. Only Xi can unlock the door.

Arthur Liu, a Tiananmen Square refugee, is the father of Olympic gold medalist Alysia Liu.

Breastfeeding + LA Runway = Magic

As a mother and a nurse in LA, I'm tired of feeling invisible. Yet even in Los Angeles — one of the most cosmopolitan cities in the world — I've struggled to choose between feeding my baby and being seen and present in my community.

Motherhood is everywhere in our city and culture. Yet breastfeeding mothers are still expected to disappear. That's wrong. So we set about to create change.

Now, models are suddenly taking to the LA runway with breastfeeding infants. It sounds like a fashion revolution — and perhaps it is.

Last month, we hosted "Breastfeeding on the Runway" at the historic Leimert Park in South LA. Four mothers walked the runway with their babies and breastfed them as part of the celebration.

For me, this moment was about much more than fashion.

It was about mothers' place in our community.

I am a board-certified lactation consultant, a nurse of more than a decade, a nonprofit CEO, a Black woman and a mother of four. I have breastfed all four of my children, including my twins, who recently turned 1.

I know firsthand that breastfeeding is beautiful, exhausting, empowering, inconvenient, emotional and deeply personal.

It's also something to celebrate.

Los Angeles, an epicenter of fashion, constantly celebrates women's bodies. We celebrate pregnancy. We celebrate curves. We celebrate confidence. We celebrate individuality.

But when a woman uses that

We simply refuse to accept the idea that breastfeeding moms should be invisible.

same body to feed her baby, suddenly there can be discomfort.

I want to change that.

That is where the idea for Breastfeeding on the Runway came from.

I run a nonprofit that helps mothers overcome barriers to care and access the education, resources and support they need to navigate breastfeeding and postpartum life, particularly in underserved communities.

I know how invisible new mothers can feel. I've felt it myself.

So I considered: What would happen if we took breastfeeding out of the places where society expects it to remain hidden and put it somewhere completely unexpected?

The runway. Yes. The response was powerful.

When four mothers breastfed their babies while walking the runway, and they were not asked to cover up or step away.

Instead, they were celebrated.

Several designers supported the vision, showing that breastfeeding and fashion need not exist in separate worlds.

The event also happened at a meaningful time: Not only is August is National Breastfeeding Month, but our event landed during Black Breastfeeding Week,

BREANNA KUIMI

making the celebration especially significant to me as a Black mom and healthcare professional.

Holding it in LA's Leimert Park made the moment even more meaningful. This was not simply a runway. It was a statement about Black motherhood, visibility, culture and community.

And then something happened that made the timing even more striking. On Sept. 21, London designer Di Petsa presented her "Holy Milk" collection during London Fashion Week.

Our Los Angeles event hap-

pened first.

That chronology matters to me — not because I believe Los Angeles has to compete with London, but because it shows that mothers here were already challenging the boundaries of fashion.

We pioneered this particular concept in Los Angeles: a nonprofit-led runway where real mothers actually breastfed their babies while being celebrated.

We simply refuse to accept the idea that breastfeeding mothers should be invisible.

That is the revolution I wanted to start. Because when a mother walks onto a runway carrying her baby, she is carrying more than a child. She is carrying a message.

She is saying that motherhood belongs in the room. That breastfeeding need not be hidden. And that women should never have to choose between being mothers and being seen.

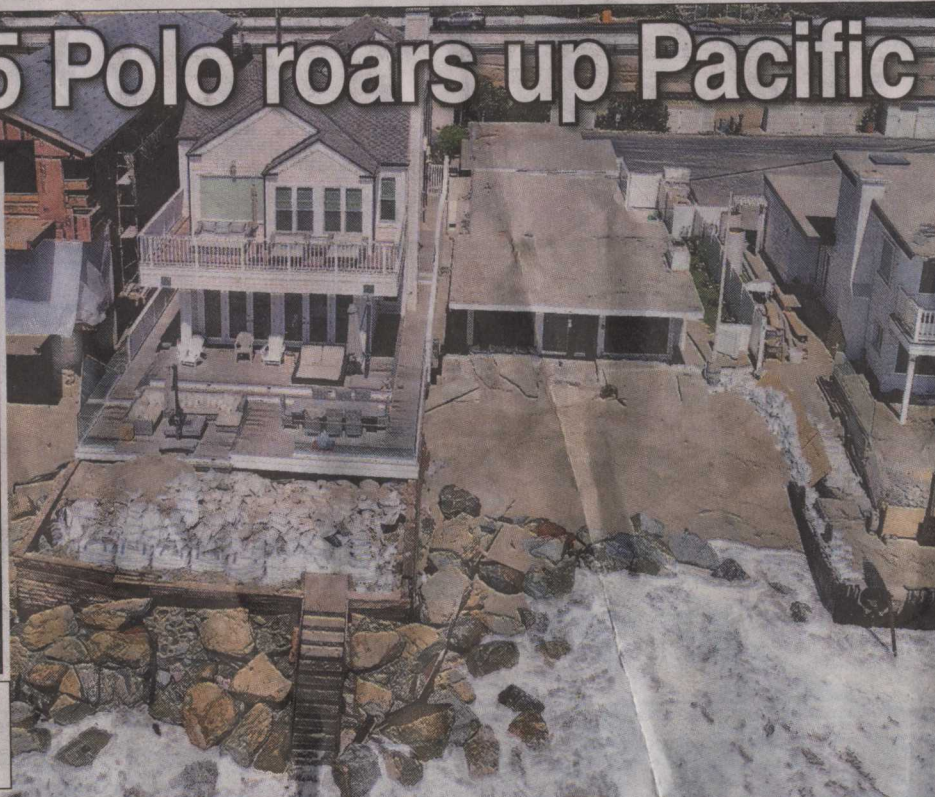
Los Angeles gave us the stage. Four mothers gave us the moment. And we gave breastfeeding an LA runway. It was magic.

Breanna Kuimi, is a mom, nurse, certified holistic nutritionist and the founder of Anew Life, a Los Angeles nonprofit providing prenatal, postpartum and lactation support to mothers and families throughout the community.

Category 5 Polo roars up Pacific



BE READY: The Southern California coast, already damaged by Hurricane Marie, could see similar water and winds brought on by Hurricane Polo (inset).



Pedro Cole for CA Post

By DANIEL FARR

Monster storm off Mex. coast

Hurricane Polo has exploded into a monstrous Category 5 storm with 180-mph winds, becoming the second-strongest hurricane ever recorded in the eastern Pacific as it threatens Mexico's southwestern coast with life-threatening floods and mudslides.

The National Hurricane Center said Polo was still strengthening after rapidly intensifying on Tuesday. The storm is expected to remain "extremely dangerous" for the next several days as it tracks northwestward over an ocean environment loaded with extremely warm water, abundant moisture and low wind shear.

'Incredible developments'

"Therefore even more strengthening is possible," the hurricane center warned, raising the prospect of an even more powerful storm as Polo continues feeding on the overheated Pacific. Atmospheric scientist Matthew Cap-

pucci offered a jaw-dropping description of the hurricane's explosive development when he wrote, "INCREDIBLE developments with Superhurricane Polo, which likely now has winds in the 175+ mph range. It has heated the air enough to lift HALF A TRILLION pounds of air out the middle, driving an incredible vacuum effect that's resulting in obscene winds."

Mexico is facing the most immediate threat, with Polo expected to drench southwestern coastal areas through Thursday even though the hurricane itself is forecast to remain offshore.

Forecasters have warned that rainfall could produce life-threatening flooding and mudslides, particularly in steep terrain, while tropical storm warnings have been

issued for parts of southwestern Mexico.

Southern California is expected to escape the worst, although the massive storm could still stir up trouble along a coastline that has already endured repeated pounding from Pacific weather.

Polo is the 16th named storm of the eastern Pacific season and the third Category 5 hurricane.

Traffic worry as BART teeters

Bay Area drivers already facing some of the most expensive commutes in the nation could be thrust into even more rush-hour chaos if the region's public transit system collapses, according to a study released Tuesday.

The Bay Area Rapid Transit system, known to millions as BART, is staring down a massive financial crisis as ridership remains far below pre-pandemic levels and officials scramble for new tax dollars to keep trains running.

The study by the San Francisco Bay Area Planning and Urban Research Association looked at the region's three biggest highway bottlenecks during peak hour traffic — the Bay Bridge, Caldecott Tunnel and Interstate 680 — and what would happen if local public transportation systems don't get funding to make up for severe budget deficits that could happen as early as 2027.

During the morning commutes, the time traveled though those pathways would require an additional 15 to 33 minutes if service cuts happen, the study claimed. In the evening, drivers would add 20 to 43 minutes onto their travel time.

For the Bay Bridge, drivers would essentially see commutes more than double in duration, the study claimed.

The group says cuts would add more than 498 million vehicle miles traveled each year after 430,000 people lose access to BART if their nearest station closes. The cuts could saddle commuters with \$3,280 annually for fuel, tolls and parking, the group said.

Titus Wu

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LOTTERY

CALIFORNIA

■ Daily 3 Midday Tue.: 435

■ Daily 3 Evening Tue.: 945

■ Daily 4 Tue.: 9284

■ Fantasy 5 Tue.: 4, 5, 25,

27, 36

■ Mega Millions Fri.: 4, 9,

24, 56, 68; Mega Ball: 1

■ SuperLotto Plus Sat.: 9,

11, 12, 14, 30; Mega Ball: 21

■ Powerball Mon.: 2, 7, 9,

17, 58; Powerball: 20

NEW YORK

■ Midday Nos. Tue.: 764

■ Midday Win-4 Tue.: 8401

■ Midday Take-5 Tue.: 9, 14, 25, 36, 37

■ Evening Nos. Mon.: 046

■ Evening Win-4 Mon.: 4306

■ Evening Take-5 Mon.: 21, 26, 27, 31, 36

■ Pick-10 Mon.: 1, 2, 16, 17,

21, 27, 33, 37, 38, 41, 45, 48,

51, 53, 58, 61, 69, 72, 74, 77

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Best Bets

What's on Tonight



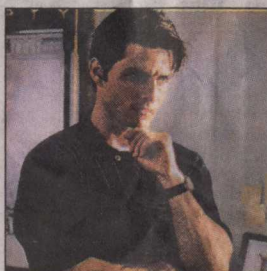
COMEDY

The Hangover: 10 p.m. on PARMT. Bradley Cooper, Zach Galifianakis. Three buddies wake up from a party with no memory of the previous night.



ACTION

Creed: 10:10 on MGM Plus. Sylvester Stallone, Michael B. Jordan. Rocky Balboa serves as a trainer and mentor to Adonis Johnson, the son of his late friend.



DRAMA

Jerry Maguire 11:30 on FX. Cuba Gooding Jr, Tom Cruise. A successful sports agent fights for his ideals and those who depend on him.

Wednesday September 23, 2026

SP = Spectrum LA, AT = AT&T LA, CI = Cox Irvine Movies Sports New

Evening	SP	AT	CI	6:30pm	7:00pm	7:30pm	8:00pm	8:30pm	9:00pm	9:30pm	10:00pm	10:30pm	11:00pm	11:30pm
2	KCBS	2	2	2	CBS Evening News	Inside Edition	Entertainment Tonight	Survivor "Survivor: Season 51 Premiere"			Big Brother		CBS LA at 11pm	(11:35) Comics Unleashed
4	KNBC	4	4	4	NBC Nightly News	NBC4 News At 7 PM	Hollywood Reeltime	The Voice "The Blind Auditions Part 3"		America's Got Talent "Finale Results" Recap Show			NBC4 News At 11 PM	(11:35) Tonight Show
5	KTLA	5	5	5	KTLA 5 News at 6:30	KTLA 5 News At 7:00	LA Unscripted	Police 24/7 "Police 24/7 203A"		Great American Road Rally: Celebrity Edition	KTLA 5 News At 10:00	(10:45) KTLA 5 (Live)	KTLA 5 News At 11:00	(11:35) Friends
7	KABC	7	7	7	ABC World News	Jeopardy!	Wheel of Fortune	Who Wants To Be A Millionaire		Who Wants To Be A Millionaire	Shark Tank		News (Live)	(11:35) Jimmy Kimmel Live
9	KCAL	9	9	9	Family Feud "Chapter 15"	Family Feud	Family Feud	CBS LA at 8pm		CBS LA at 9pm	CBS LA at 10pm	(10:45) Sports Central	America's Funniest	America's Funniest
11	KTTV	11	11	11	News (Live)	Extra	TMZ	The Floor "100 Champions Enter the Ring"	99 to Beat "Premiere: Do You Believe in Miracles?"		Good Nite LA	West Coast News Wrap	Good Nite LA	Front Office Sports
13	KCOP	13	13	13	West Coast News Wrap	NHL Preseason Hockey Los Angeles Kings at Anaheim Ducks (Live)				News (Live)	48 Hours "Who Poisoned Angela Craig?"		Good Nite LA	West Coast News Wrap
30	KPXN	30	30	8	(5:55) BlueBlood	(6:55) Blue Bloods		Blue Blood "Smack Attack"	Blue Bloods "Brothers"		Blue Bloods "Chinatown"		Blue Bloods	
34	KMEX	10	12	34	Noticiero N+	La rosa de Guadalupe		Tan Cerca de Ti, Nace	Tierra de Amor y Coraje		Corazón de oro		Noticiero N+	Noticiero N+
46	KFTX	21	20	42	(6:00) As	Lo tomas o lo dejas		Survivor (2015,Action) Milla Jovovich. ★★			Desafío The Box 2023		Sin Miedo a La Verdad	
50	KOCE	16	50	10	(6:00) News	Big Cats 24/7 "Episode 3"		Big Cats 24/7 "Episode 4"	NOVA		Ages of Ice "Polar Seas"		Weathered	Weathered
52	KVEA	12	52	36	Noticias	Top Chef VIP			El Señor de los Cielos		Lejos de Ti		Noticiero (11:35) Noticias	
58	KLCS	15	58	38	News	The Marlow Murder Club		Marble "Episode 1"	Downton "Part Three"		Sustaining Everybody		LA County Board of	
A&E	49	132	67		Live PD	Live PD	Live PD	Live PD	Live PD	Live PD	Live PD	Live PD	(11:05) Live PD	(11:35) Live PD
AMC	46	119	66		Movie	Ferris Bueller's Day Off (1986,Comedy) Matthew Broderick. ★★			True Lies (1994,Action) Arnold Schwarzenegger. ★★					
BBCAM	110	122	346		(4:30) Cape Fear ★★		The Shining (1980,Horror) Jack Nicholson. ★★							The Terror
BET	52	156	48		(6:00) Celebrity	Celebrity Family Feud		Celebrity Family Feud	The Oval		All "Trick Daddy"		Martin	(11:35) Martin
BRAVO	76	181	55		(6:00) RealHou..	Real Housewives of Salt		Real Housewives of Salt	Next Gen NYC		Watch What	The Real Housewives of Salt Lake City		
CNBC	33	216	44		(6:00) SharkTa..	WNBA Basketball (Live)			American Greed			American	Dateline "True Confession"	
CNN	37	202	14		(6:00) Source	CNN NewsNight		Laura Coates Live	Story Is w/ Elex		Story Is w/ Elex		Anderson Cooper 360	
COMEDY	67	141	60		South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	Daily Show	SouthPark
DISC	73	121	21		(6:00) How To	How to Catch a Dirtbag		How to Catch a Dirtbag	How to Catch a Dirtbag		How to Catch a Dirtbag		How to Catch a Dirtbag	
DISNEY	54	303	20		Big City	Big City	Big City	Phineas	Phineas		Phineas	Kiff	Miraculous	Miraculous
E!	51	135	59		How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met		National Lampoon's Christmas Vacation ★★	
ESPN	64	602	15		(4:00) MLBBas..	MLB Baseball Houston Astros vs. Seattle Mariners (Live)					SportsCenter (Live)		SportsCenter (Live)	
ESPN2	65	606	16		(6:00) SEC Storie	NFL Live		ESPN Orig "Them Dawgs"	College	The Schrager Hour		Pardon	E60	
FBN	86	211	81		(6:00) HowAm..	How Americ "Waste"		How Americ "Pipelines"	How America Works		Paid Progr	Paid Progr	Paid Progr	Paid Progr
FNC	32	210	46		(6:00) Hannity	Gutfeld!		Fox News at Night (Live)	The Five		Jesse Watters Primetime		Hannity	
FOOD	53	453	56		(6:00) Guy'sGroc	Guy's Groc "Friend to Foe"		Guy's Grocery Games	Guy's Grocery Games		Guy's Grocery Games		Guy's Grocery Games	
FREE	122	179	19		Toy Story 3 (4097)				(8:55) Toy Story 4 (2019,Family) Tom Hanks. ★★				The 700 Club	
FS1	95	652	73		NASCAR Special Suárez	All In		High Limit Racing Series Kokomo Speedway			TMZ Sports	NFL Films	NCAA College Football	
FX	43	129	17		(5:30) Captain Marvel ('19,Sci-Fi) ★★			Captain America: Civil War (2016,Action) Chris Evans. ★★						Movie
HALL	88	365	76		(6:00) Absolutely Devoted to You			Haul Out the Halloween ('25,Romance) ★★			Golden	Golden	Golden	Golden
HGTV	74	451	57		(6:00) HouseSh..	House Hunt	House Hunt	House Hunt	House Hunt	Totally '90s House	Botched Homes		House Hunt	House Hunt
HIST	72	256	62		(6:00) PawnSta..	Pawn Stars		Pawn Stars	Pawn Stars		(10:05) Pawn Stars		(11:05) Pawn Stars	
ID	71	260	88		(6:00) American	American Monster		American Monster	Murder In The Heart Of Texas				American "Double Take"	
LIFE	47	361	58		(6:00) Rizzoli	Rizzoli & Isles		Rizzoli "Burden of Proof"	Rizzoli & Isles		(10:05) Rizzoli "Foot Loose"		(11:05) Rizzoli "Gumshoe"	
LMN	83	362	345		Movie	Secret Life of a Sorority Girl ('24,Thriller) ★★		Killing all my Sisters ('24,Thriller) Isabella Carlsen. ★★			Secret Life of a Sorority Girl		Secret Life of a Sorority Girl	
MSNOW	34	215	43		(6:00) Briefing	Last Word (Live)		The Briefing with Jen Psaki	Last Word w/ Lawrence				11th Hour w/ Ali Velshi	
MTV	58	503	49		Big Bang	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office
NATGEO	75	265	108		(6:00) Airport	Airport "Sewn-in Stash"		Airport "Cocaine Cop"	Airport "Cocaine CEO"		Airport "Sneaky Seniors"		Airport "Cocaine Carnival"	
NICK	56	315	70		SpongeBob	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Big Bang	(10:40) Big Bang	(11:15) Big Bang	(11:50) Big Bang
OWN	91	170	105		My Lottery	My Lottery	My Lottery	My Lottery	My Lottery	My Lottery	My Lottery	My Lottery	My Lottery	My Lottery
PARMT	45	146	52		(6:00) BarResc..	Bar Rescue		Bar Rescue	Bar Rescue		The Hangover (2009,Comedy) Zach Galifianakis. ★★			
SSN	59	777	65		Access SportsNet: Lakers	Beyond		Beyond	Beyond		Access SportsNet: Lakers		LakeShow	Sportico
SSNLA	70	780			Access	MLB Baseball San Diego Padres at Los Angeles Dodgers					Access SportsNet: Dodgers		MLB Baseball	
SYFY	66	152	61		Movie	The Hunger Games: Catching Fire (2013,Action) Jennifer Lawrence. ★★					The Ark "Critical Failure"		The Forever Purge ★★	
TBS	41	113	27		Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	All Elite Wrestling: Dynamite "Dynamite 9/23/2026"			All Elite Wrestling		All Elite	The Office
TCM	631	790	28		Movie	Gay Purr-ee (1962,Animated) ★★		Movie	The Phantom Tollbooth ★★				Vertigo ('58,Thriller) ★★	
TLC	48	251	54		(6:00) One Day	ER: Caught On Camera		ER: Caught On Camera	ER: Caught On Camera		The Bad Skin Clinic		1000-lb "Step Yo Game Up"	
TNT	42	109	3		(5:00) Jurassic World: Fallen K...	Jumanji: Welcome to the Jungle (2017,Action) Dwayne Johnson. ★★		Jumanji: Welcome to the Jungle (2017,Action) Dwayne Johnson. ★★			Jumanji: Welcome to the Jungle		Jumanji: Welcome to the Jungle	
TVLAND	44	139	69		(6:25) Andy Griff	Everybody	Everybody	Everybody	Everybody	(9:20) Everybody "The Skit"	Everybody	Everybody	King of	King of
USA	40	125	22		(6:00) 9-1-1	9-1-1		WNBA Baske Atlanta Dream at New York Liberty (Live)			WNBA Basketball Dallas Wings at Seattle Storm (Live)			
VH1	50	519	50		Everybody	Everybody	Everybody	Love & Basketball (2000,Romance) Sanaa Lathan. ★★					Bring it On ★★	
WE	92	373	371		(6:00) NCIS	NCIS "Once a Hero"		NCIS "Twisted Sister"	NCIS "Smoked"		NCIS "Driven"		NCIS "Suspicion"	
HBO	511	803	200		(6:40) Lanterns	"Chapter 6"	(7:40) Youth	(8:05) Youth	(8:40) Jay-z In 8	(9:20) Jay-z In 8 "Chapter 2"	Contagion ('11,Drama) ★★			(11:50) Youth
MAX	531	833	220		(5:50) The Lobster ★★		(7:50) On Becoming a Guinea Fowl ('24,Drama) ★★		Birds of Prey: & the Fantabulous Emancipa...		(11:20) Joker ★★			
MGM+	595	892	310		(6:20) American	(7:05) American Hostage		Roofman (2025,Crime Story) Channing Tatum. ★★			(10:10) Creed (2015,Drama) Michael B. Jordan. ★★			
PARSHO	551	853	240		(6:25) Smart People ('08,Drama) ★★			Just Go With It (2011,Romance) Adam Sandler. ★★			He's Just Not That Into You ('09,Drama) ★★			
TMC	571	853	260		(5:55) Shakespeare In Love ★★			Doin' It (2024,Comedy) Lilly Singh. ★★		(9:40) Young Adult ★★			(11:15) Life During Wartime	

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CALIFORNIA POST

To Save the UN

In his strong, clear speech at the United Nations, President Trump took credit for his accomplishments abroad while slamming the world body's dysfunction.

His UN addresses from the start have been top-notch statesmanship — and prophetic: The Germans laughed at his 2018 warning not to depend on Russian energy ... until the tanks rolled into Ukraine in '22.

On Tuesday he again held a clear mirror up to the all-talk, no-walk crowd — and if the UN fails to get the message, its days may be numbered.

Trump touted America's rebound since his return to the White House and trumpeted his effective work to "reshape the world stage": his peace deals, his Venezuela move, his Greenland entente and, above all, his defanging of Iran.

Indeed, he vowed to "annihilate" the Islamic Republic if it refuses to make an acceptable deal. "I have no interest in leaving dangers to grow for another day," he explained. "So, while others have talked, I have acted." Hear, hear.

And while Trump unabashedly puts US interests first, his emphasis on action is a

clear indictment of Turtle Bay's failure in its primary mission: to confront threats to world peace, such as Iran poses.

The prez was even more explicit in his disdain for UN efforts to impose a "far-left agenda" and for its "globalists," "rogue" International Criminal Court, Human Rights Council and UNESCO.

Yes, "the United Nations has great, great potential," Trump allowed; his criticisms aim to save it. But that requires a massive shift in UN culture — and leadership.

Secretary-General António Guterres' decade of misrule has seen the bureaucracy bloat and rot — not just failing to step up to world challenges, but adding to them. Israel has ID'd 1,500 UN employees as members of Hamas or allied terror groups; many joined in the Oct. 7 rape-kill-and-kidnap atrocities.

Absent deep UN reform, the world will look elsewhere, to Trump's Board of Peace or other bodies that can do effective work.

The League of Nations, like the UN, failed its mission to address conflicts fairly and effectively — and melted away as Hitler marched. Trump still hopes the United Nations can do better ... if it listens.

At Last, a Hollywood Ending

The Paramount-Warner Bros. deal is going through — and that's a good thing. We said California Attorney General Rob Bonta should reach an agreement — and he did.

Left-wing activists are upset. "Gavin Newsom hands huge win to Trump and his billionaire cronies," said Hollywood actor Mark Ruffalo. "Hate to say it but we all got played," he added.

They did. Because this was all about politics for Bonta. It was never really about consolidation.

The five-year deal is a no-brainer, from the perspective of saving jobs and protecting the US film industry. Hollywood stood to lose tens of thousands of jobs, and billions of dollars in economic activity, if the deal fell through and Paramount left for Nashville. It was not a real possibility.

Gavin Newsom did not want that failure on his resume before a presidential run. While the Paramount talks were going on

he made sure to sign post-production tax credits into law — a message to Bonta, and Paramount.

Instead of losing two studios, Hollywood will keep a larger one — with some job cuts at first, but with prospects of future success, as the company retools for the streaming content era.

The AG says he's still upset about the merger. But his real objection — like that of most Democrats — was that the Ellison family stood to gain control of CNN, in addition to CBS News, which David Ellison's Skydance bought last year.

It's ironic that the same crowd that accuses President Donald Trump of trying to control the media by pulling White House access wants to control the media by controlling who owns what.

But cooler heads have prevailed, showing California still has some common sense and good will, even if they take a while to turn up.

Where's the Deterrence?

California universities say they are trying to send a tougher message on antisemitism. Maybe they should tell the legal system to wake up as well.

Thirteen Stanford students were arrested in June 2024 for breaking into the offices of the Stanford University administration.

According to the university, the students broke into the administration offices, began vandalizing them, and barricaded themselves inside. The incident took place at the height of the "encampment" movement, in which anti-Israel activists occupied universities' campuses in tent cities. Some specif-

ically targeted Jews; others simply made Jewish students, faculty, and staff uncomfortable with pro-terror rhetoric and occasional violence. The Stanford Daily said that the students who broke into the administration were pro-Palestinian activists.

This week, California Attorney General Rob Bonta, who had taken over the case, dropped felony charges against five defendants. The defendants have agreed to pay restitution and do community service.

That's hardly much of a deterrent.

California missed an opportunity to send a clear message against violence and hatred.

letters@californiapost.com

A Presidential Press Ban: An Overreach or Overdue?

THE ISSUE: President Trump banning MS NOW, CNN and Politico reporters from the White House.



President Trump

press and being the mouthpiece of a regime. **Jane Tarbet**

Highland, Mich.

George Magakis Jr.
Norristown, Pa.

•It's been obvious for a long time that MS NOW, CNN and Politico don't have America's interests at heart. One can listen to the president speak and then read something published by these three outlets that is twisted in such a way that it does not even come close to what he actually said.

The press has an obligation to report the news, factually and in an unbiased manner. MS Now, CNN and Politico have forgotten that. There's a difference between the freedom of the

•The president is wrong; no journalists should be banned. Former President Barack Obama was also wrong in removing conservative newspapers from his press plane and attempting to block Fox News from an interview.

How about we stop the finger-pointing from both sides? Also, the press should stop the inflammatory comments and be a little more objective.

Marianne Haas
Berkeley, Calif.

•I believe in freedom of the

press. However, covering the White House is a privilege, not a right.

Robert Berk, Manhattan, NY

•The sound of silence can be very loud, as President Trump has found out. The opening of his White House helicopter landing pad was shown but not heard, an oddity in modern news reporting but all his own doing.

By trying to silence several media outlets, he has attacked the freedom of the press and the First Amendment and won himself a fightback with decreased coverage by protesting news outlets.

It's tempting to be pleased with the reduced coverage of Trump, but any restriction to public debate is wrong and a worrying sign that must be called out loudly.

Dennis Fitzgerald
Box Hill, Australia

•This sounds slightly familiar. What's the ancient story concerning the king who received bad news from the battlefield and had the messenger killed?

Hank Taylor
Bryan, Texas

Our Shelter-Like Streets

THE ISSUE: Homelessness in New York City reaching a five-year high under NYC's Mayor Zohran Mamdani.

•Maybe the people who voted for Mayor Mamdani want to take some of the homeless people home ("Curb surge of despair," Sept. 19).

The result of their vote has had consequences for all New Yorkers. The smell of urine and the homeless shantytown is on them.

Give the rest of us shelter from their morally bankrupt ideas.

Peter Cooper, Bronxville, NY

•Congratulations, Mamdani, on your triumph in socialist policies regarding homelessness.

These policies have allowed the homeless population in New York City to grow — and the mayor has addressed the concerns about the homeless with great efficiency, making it a much better life journey for

them.

Hopefully, the good mayor will develop a Yelp review program so the homeless can better decide where they will sleep at night. Maybe the progressive students at NYU can help move this program along.

Michael Patracuolla
Bloomfield, NJ

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Young puritans: No sex, no alcohol

ANDREA PALLADINO



GEN Z is going through a dry spell.

The Kinsey Institute, the storied sex foundation, surveyed 2,373 US adults aged 18 to 29 to understand how young adults are navigating sex, dating and relationships today.

The key takeaway was depressing: Most young adults report low levels of sexual activity overall. The survey found 29% had zero partners in the past three months, while 19% have never had a sexual partner at all.

And yet only 18% of study participants reported being “unsatisfied” with their sex lives, although the majority of young people surveyed would happily jump at the chance to jump in bed with a Jacob Elordi look-alike, saying their sex drives are “moderate to high.”

Reasons vary

What's stopping Gen Z from getting X-rated?

As a 22-year-old reporting from the front line, I can tell you that the deterrent is different for everyone.

Some fear having intimate details shared in a fraternity or sorority alumni chat with literally hundreds of people.

Others want an emotional connection first, but don't know how to find it when people seem to be less flirtatious in person, even if their digital “selves” are down-right spicy.

And others simply don't care. There's less taboo around masturbation and self-pleasure, so people are content with going home rather than risking the social suicide of rejection.

According to interviews I did, Gen Z would prefer to have phone sex or send nude photos over text to fill our desire quota. We grew up with the instant

gratification of the internet, after all.

Kyle Ramsingh, 22, from Queens, told The Post, “My friends find pleasure over the phone rather than physical intimacy. It's easy, and there's really no commitment because the chances aren't high that you'll ever meet that person... I don't want to say Gen Z is taking the easy way out, but it's more of a virtual approach to intimacy.”

Then there's social media and the internet.

A 22-year-old Gen Zer from New York City told The Post that

her main deterrent from sex was the fear of becoming a screenshot in a group chat.

Screenshot fears

“Social media and reputation now make private information spread so fast,” she told The Post. “Screenshots, private messages and gossip can reach an entire social circle almost immediately, which made me hesitant about sex before my relationship.”

Still, some sexless Gen Z members are optimistic.

A 23-year-old recent graduate

in Washington, DC, told The Post that maybe there's a “dip” in her love life, but she doesn't think it'll last.

“I think right now, we are able to replace companionship in the digital world, but it will be an ebb and flow. People will go back to having more sex, especially because the replacements for sex aren't complete replacements. They only replace certain aspects,” she told The Post.

She also shared how the social media discussion surrounding “body count” — the number of people someone has slept with —

has made people feel like they don't want to “gain a number.”

“I don't want to be sleeping with people aimlessly and raising my body count. I don't care what other people's body counts are, but mine personally grosses me out and I wish I could take back the majority of them,” she shared with The Post. “I think after having sex with someone I love, there is a lot more on my mind now.”

And when asked if she is fine without sex, she told The Post, “Flirting at the bar and using my vibrator is good enough for me.”



Getty Images

Imbibing is off . . . but not for old fogies

Americans are finally starting to feel the boozy hangover from COVID-19.

Alcohol consumption in America dropped for the first time since the pandemic, a study found, but older generations are still boozing at elevated rates.

Instead, it's millennials who are reporting less

heavy drinking.

Adult alcohol drinkers — at least one drink over a year — fell by 2% from 2022 to 2024, a recently published study from USC Los Angeles' Dr. Brian P. Lee found. Heavy drinking — five drinks daily or 15 weekly for men, and four daily or eight weekly for

women — dropped even more, slipping by 8% during that time.

“Seeing this first decline gives you something to hope for as a doctor, but you have to be appropriately cautious, too,” Lee told CNN. “One change doesn't necessarily mean a sustained trend.”

Lee's study supported his caution: Despite the recent declines, people were still drinking at higher rates in 2024 than they were in 2018.

He first identified a spike in pandemic drinking in a 2024 study which found the portion of Americans who drink increased about

3% between 2018 and 2022, from 66.34% before the pandemic and 69.3% after.

And while drinking overall was creeping down overall, that wasn't the case for all age groups. Younger people were quitting the sauce at higher rates than older folks, who continued to imbibe above

pre-pandemic levels.

Gen Zers, people 18 to 29, saw all alcohol use drop 5% from 2022 to 2024, while heavy drinking among millennials, aged 30 to 49, fell 17%.

But both boomers and Gen X continued to drink at pre-pandemic levels.

Alex Oliveira